# Learn Words About a New Subject

**Directions** Below and on page 164 are five questions that you might find on a test. Read the text to learn more about these words.

## Sample Test Questions



The key word **judgment** tells you to give your reasoned opinion.



The key word **elaborate** tells you to develop a thought more fully by adding details and examples.

### Vocabulary Words

**classify**
**elaborate**
**evidence**
**judgment**
**revise**

### Word Learning Tip!

You have learned that every subject has special words. These words may be long or short, but they almost always describe challenging parts of the subject. They are not words that you see when you read about other topics. To learn these words, think about the subject of the passage. Then consider what part of the topic each word gives you information about. In this lesson, all of the words relate to test-taking.

### Vocabulary Building Strategy

Every time you come to a word that you don't know, see how that word relates to the subject and the other new words. This will help you define the word because you know that all the content words describe something specific about the subject. Then add what you know about the subject to all of the other content words you know to find the exact meaning of the new word.


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# Learn Words About a New Subject



The key word **revise** tells you to make changes in what you wrote or what you do to make it better.



The key word **evidence** tells you to give facts, details, and examples to support a conclusion.



The key word **classify** tells you to put things into groups according to their characteristics or traits.


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# Connect Words and Meanings

| classify | elaborate | evidence | judgment | revise |
|---|---|---|---|---|

**Directions** Read each definition below. In the blank, write the vocabulary word that matches the definition. Then use the word in the sentence that follows the definition.

1. **Definition** proof; details, facts, and examples that help you prove something or convince others that it is true: _____

2. Remember to provide _____ to back up your ideas.

3. **Definition** to change and correct something to improve it: _____

4. It's important to _____ your work to make sure it is clear and easy to read.

5. **Definition** add details to make fuller or more complete: _____

6. This passage is too skimpy. Please _____ by adding more concrete details.

7. **Definition** an informed opinion, evaluation, or decision: _____

8. Make a _____ after you have evaluated both sides of the argument and looked at the facts.

9. **Definition** put things into groups according to their characteristics or traits: _____

10. The question asked the students to _____ countries by their type of government.

**Paraphrase Definitions** In your personal word journal, put each of the definitions in your own words. Then write a sentence using each word.


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# Use Content Words

| classify | elaborate | evidence | judgment | revise |
|---|---|---|---|---|

**Directions** Read the direction lines below. Write the vocabulary word in the blank that most closely matches each item.

1. Reread your response. Then make any changes necessary to make your ideas clearer.
   This direction tells me to _____.

2. Make sure you develop your answer fully by including details and examples.
   This direction tells me to _____.

3. Arrange the documents to show which ones were top secret and which were available to the public.
   This direction tells me to _____.

4. Give three facts to prove that people should stay physically fit.
   This direction tells me to use _____.

5. Agree or disagree with this statement: Voting should be done over the Internet.
   This direction tells me to make a _____.

6. Develop this main idea: Dogs are good pets. Include details and examples in your response.
   This direction tells me to _____.

7. Express your opinion about the following statement: Students should wear uniforms to school.
   This direction tells me to make a _____.

8. Group the different ways the students tried to earn money for the charity. Tell whether they provided a service or made and sold a product.
   This direction tells me to _____.

**Write Test-Taking Tips** Working with some classmates, write five test-taking tips. Use at least one content word in each tip. Base your tips on your own test-taking experience so they are helpful for your classmates.


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# Put Words Into Action

| classify | elaborate | evidence | judgment | revise |
|---|---|---|---|---|

**Directions** Here are some comments that a teacher might write in response to your work on a test. Write the correct vocabulary in the blanks.

1. You have not supported your _____ or opinion. Please back it up with facts.
2. Please _____, because this passage is too skimpy. Include sensory details that help the reader see, feel, taste, hear, and smell that place you are describing.
3. The organization of your response is weak. Please _____ by reordering the events and placing them in time order.
4. Include more _____ to support your opinion.
5. _____ the people Amelia knows as either friends or foes. This will help the reader better understand the conflict in the story.
6. This passage is hard to follow and the points you make are not clear. Please _____ what you have written.
7. A persuasive passage needs to include more _____. Add more facts and examples to convince your readers of your point.
8. _____ on your ideas by adding details and explaining them better.
9. The writing prompt asked you to make a _____, or tell whether or not you agree with the author. In your response, please make your opinion clearer.
10. You did not _____ the states that fought for the North and South in the Civil War. Look back at the prompt and group the states under the correct headings.

**Write a Test With a Partner** Work with a partner. Write five questions you would ask on a test about your favorite subject. Use all vocabulary words and two new test-taking words.


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# Review and Extend

| classify | elaborate | evidence | judgment | revise |
|---|---|---|---|---|

**Bonus Words** Here are two new words about test-taking. These two words deal with the same big idea as the five words you have already learned. This tells you that even if these words are new to you, you can link them to what you have already learned about test-taking words.

**observation** seeing or noticing
**quote** to repeat words exactly

**Directions** Read each sentence below. Choose the vocabulary word or bonus word that best completes each sentence. Write the word in the blank. You will use each content or bonus word only once.

1. Make sure you use quotation marks when you _____ a person's exact words.

2. Esther wanted to _____ her composition to make sure her sentences were well constructed and her ideas were clear.

3. On the science test, George had to _____ or group the clouds according to the way they looked.

4. It's a good night for _____ of the skies, because we can see many different stars and planets.

5. To support her opinion, Jade provided a lot of _____ as proof, including interesting facts about the topic.

6. It is important to _____, or include enough details, when you write. But include only details that relate to your point.

**Find More Test-Taking Words** Look through your textbooks to find more words related to test-taking. Here are five new words to get you started: *evaluate*, *sequence*, *infer*, *predict*, *synthesize*. In your personal word journal, write all the words and their definitions. Tell which words you would use the most and why.


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# Check Your Mastery

**Directions** Read each item below. Then write the vocabulary word that best completes each sentence. Use each vocabulary word twice.

**1.** Make sure that you _____ on your ideas by adding details and examples.
**A.** elaborate **B.** judgment **C.** classify

**2.** Regan had to _____ insects according to their body types and number of legs.
**A.** judgment **B.** classify **C.** elaborate

**3.** Before you can make a(n) _____, you have to evaluate all the choices.
**A.** evidence **B.** elaborate **C.** judgment

**4.** "Always _____ and proofread your essay tests before you hand them in," the teacher said.
**A.** evidence **B.** revise **C.** classify

**5.** Ravi used a lot of _____ to back up his ideas, so his essay had good details and examples.
A. evidence **B.** revise **C.** elaborate

**6.** When you _____ your paper, you make changes to improve the way it is written.
**A.** elaborate **B.** classify **C.** revise

**7.** If you don't _____ on your main ideas, your paper will lack specific facts.
**A.** judgment **B.** classify **C.** elaborate

**8.** When a question asks you to make a _____, it is asking for your opinion.
**A.** judgment **B.** revise **C.** classify

**9.** As _____ to support her point, Cheryl listed many facts.
**A.** classify **B.** judgment **C.** evidence

**10.** On the test, Lauren had to _____ presidents according to their political parties.
**A.** judgment **B.** classify **C.** elaborate


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